

developed a distinctive, eclectic style that owed little to German Romanticism and more to the folk-inspired nostalgia associated with English pastoral music. Surprisingly, however, his music became popular with German conductors and audiences, while comparatively unknown elsewhere. Nonetheless, in 1907, the conductor Thomas Beecham heard some of Delius's pieces at a concert in London, and became his most ardent champion. Encouraged by Beecham, Delius produced some of his best-known music, including *Brigg Fair*, the *Mass of Life*, *In a Summer Garden*, *On Hearing the First Cuckoo in Spring*, and *A Village Romeo and Juliet*.

During World War I, he and Jelka traveled to Norway and Britain, and visited spas in France for Frederick's health, as the effects of syphilis began to take hold. During the 1920s, as his reputation peaked, he became increasingly incapable of working; by 1928, he was blind and confined to a wheelchair. However, with help from Eric Fenby (see [box](#)), he was able to complete and revise his unfinished works, and even start new projects before his death in 1934.